'WE DELIVERED WHAT WE P

How has been your journey so far – from a non-descript tribal village to the Chief Minister's office?

I had a very simple life in my village Raikala in Kendujhar district. However, I was always inclined to serve people. From a teacher to Sarpanch, from an MLA to become the Chief Minister. I have accepted all my responsibilities with humility. Life is beautiful, if one faces challenges of life with courage and calmness.

Who is your icon? Your working style seems more like replicating PM Modi.

Not only for me, for every BJP worker as well as countless young men who are not even politically affiliated to any party, our Prime Minister is not only an icon, but also an inspiration. For me personally, there can be no one else. Prime Minister Modi ji is the most dynamic and inspiring leader of the country we have seen in a long time. It is not possible to replicate his working style or his vision. I can only draw inspiration from his passion to work for the country and people of India.



You aspire to be known as a "People's CM". What all are you doing to earn this sobriquet? It is a wrong question. Everybody as the head of the government, especially a Chief Minister, wants to be 'People's Chief Minister' which literally means that people love their Chief Minister and they see him as one of their own. Whoever is able to fulfill this simple expectation of people, they call him or her as 'People's Chief Minister'.

In my case I had taken a decision consciously to remove the artificial barrier created between the 'Chief Minister' and 'Janata' (common man). This was done though listening to the people's grievances directly by me and my cabinet colleagues in presence of the highest level officers. During the past one year, I have personally attended 11 such meetings and met about 12,000 people directly, interacted with them, listened to their problems and solving in the best possible manner. Besides, more than 5 lakh grievances have been resolved through online redressal mechanism.

Secondly, in the first year itself, I have visited all the districts of Odisha, talking to them. These twin spontaneous act has resulted in removing the wall between me and people. The people have started to call their government 'People's Government' and their Chief Minister as 'People's Chief Minister' – not claimed by me.

You have coined the slogan "Katha Dei Katha Rakhilu". Have you fulfilled all your poll promises?

That literally means, 'We had promised, we have delivered'. From the Day-1 when the Cabinet met for the first time, within 24 minutes we fulfilled four major projects like Subhadra Yojana, enhancing Rs. 800 per quintal for paddy procumbent, opening the four doors of Jagannath Temple and creating a Rs 500-crore corpus fund.

Since then, almost every other day, some scheme or some programme have been undertaken, some projects are inaugurated or some projects have started. As they call it, 'Yojana aur Karyakram ki baadh aa gayee'.

What are the major achievements of your government in last one year?

There is a long list and it is difficult to pick a few. But, specifically schemes like Subhadra, input assistance to farmers, PM Kissan Samman Nidhi and CM Kissan Nidhi are worth mentioning because these three interventions have increased the yearly income of the farming family by 50% as a minimum of Rs 30,000 were added through these direct cash schemes.

We are building world-class primary school infrastructure through Godavarish Mishra Prathamik Vidyalaya, implemented the 'New Education Policy 2020' which was kept in abeyance due to political reasons. Similarly, the government has implemented Ayushman Bharat - Jana Arogya Yojana which was denied to people of Odisha for six long years, again due to political reasons. The scheme is being implemented along with our own Gopabandhu Jana Arogya Yojana. We are working for the four categories of people as outlined by the Prime Minister – 'Poor, Annadata (farmers), Youths & Women', whom Prime Minister says are the only four castes in India.

What is your vision on taking Odisha forward?

We have prepared a Vision Document for 2036 and 2047. Our goal is to become Samruddha Odisha with an economy of USD 500 billion by 2036, and to become a major growth engine of India by 2047 with an economy by USD 1.5 trillion. For this, we have prepared 36 robust programs which will be our roadmap for future. From education, health to infrastructure and industry, we have massive plans to achieve our vision.

Like West Bengal, Odisha too has more of an 'anti-industry' image, because of scrapping of mega projects like POSCO, Kaling Nagar fiasco, Baliapal agitation, Niyamgiri issue etc. With this background, what are your plans to turn Odisha into an industrialised state?

I think you are drawing a wrong parallel here. There was never any anti-industry sentiment here. Yes, many of the projects were mishandled by the previous regime which you have mentioned rightly. They could have handled better.

As I keep on repeating that for industrialization, there need not be any 'balidan' (sacrifice). Our vision for industrialisation is based on 'sahabhagita' (partnership). People are more amenable to industry now than ever before. There

IN CONVERSATION WITH

SHRI MOHAN CHARAN MAJHI, Hon'nble Chief Minister of Odisha